

BIRAJ BISHT

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Education

University of California, Irvine PhD in Education Policy & Social Context Dissertation Committee: Emily Penner (Chair), Greg Duncan, Andrew Penner, Di Xu	Expected 2027
Brown University MA, Urban Education Policy	2019
University of Oregon, Clark Honors College BS, Economics; Mathematics Minor	2015

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

National Academy of Education/Spencer Dissertation Fellowship	2026–2027
Graduate Dean's Dissertation Fellowship, University of California, Irvine	2026–2027
Association for Education Finance and Policy Predoctoral Fellowship	2021
Clark Honors College Shephard Family Scholarship	2012–2015
Clark Honors College Senior Thesis Research Award	2014–2015

Publications

Journal Articles

- Bisht, B.**, Bonilla, S., Kim, G., & Penner, E. (2026). Cultural relevance at scale: The effects of an ethnic studies expansion on academic outcomes. *American Educational Research Journal*, 63(3), 471–513. <https://doi.org/10.3102/00028312261426338>
Media mentions: [SF Chronicle](#), [EdWorkingPapers Policy & Practice Series](#)
- Robinson, C., **Bisht, B.**, & Loeb, S. (2025). The inequity of opt-in educational resources and an intervention to increase equitable access. *Educational Researcher*, 54(6), 328–338. <https://doi.org/10.3102/0013189X251331518>
Media mentions: [Hechinger Report](#), [Brookings](#), [Education Week](#)

Working Papers

- Bisht, B.**, LeClair, Z., Loeb, S., & Sun, M. (2022). Paraeducators: Growth, diversity, and a dearth of professional supports. *Annenberg Institute EdWorkingPaper*: 21-490. <https://doi.org/10.26300/nk1z-c164>
Media mentions: [FutureEd](#), [New America](#), [Education Week](#)

Works in Progress

- Bisht, B.**, & Penner, E. *Curriculum and Students' Connection to School: Evidence from Districtwide Ethnic Studies*.
- Bisht, B.**, & Penner, E. *Race Match and Cultural Relevance: Mechanisms of Impact in Ethnic Studies Classrooms*.
- Bisht, B.**, & Penner, E. *What Do Ethnic Studies Syllabi Reveal? A Computational Text Analysis of Pedagogical Quality and Student Outcomes*.
- Why AI Tutoring Systems Struggle to Achieve Meaningful Implementation: A Districtwide Case Study*.

Research Reports

- Hanson, H., **Bisht, B.**, & Greenberg Motamedi, J. (2017). [Advanced course enrollment and performance in Washington state: Comparing Spanish-speaking students with other language minority students and English-only speakers \(REL 2017–220\)](#). *Regional Educational Laboratory Northwest*.

Deussen, T., Hanson, H., & **Bisht, B.** (2017). [Are two commonly used early warning indicators accurate predictors of dropout for English learner students? Evidence from six districts in Washington state](#) (REL 2017–261). *Regional Educational Laboratory Northwest*.

Stevens, D., & Frazelle, S., with **Bisht, B.**, & Hamilton, R. (2016). [Online credit recovery: Enrollment and passing patterns in Montana Digital Academy courses](#) (REL 2016–139). *Regional Educational Laboratory Northwest*.

Conference Presentations

Bisht, B., & Penner, E. (2026). “Race match and cultural relevance: Evidence from ethnic studies.” Association for Education Finance and Policy, Chicago, IL.

Bisht, B., & Penner, E. (2026). “Race match and cultural relevance: Evidence from ethnic studies.” Educational Opportunity Conference, Stanford University, Stanford, CA.

Bisht, B., Bonilla, S., Kim, G., & Penner, E. (2025). “Cultural relevance at scale: The effects of an ethnic studies expansion on academic outcomes.” Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness, Chicago, IL.

Bisht, B., Bonilla, S., Kim, G., & Penner, E. (2025). “Cultural relevance at scale: The effects of an ethnic studies expansion on academic outcomes.” American Educational Research Association, Denver, CO.

Bisht, B., LeClair, Z., Loeb, S., & Sun, M. (2022). “Paraeducators: Growth, diversity, and a dearth of professional supports.” Association for Education Finance and Policy, Denver, CO.

Robinson, C., **Bisht, B.**, & Loeb, S. (2022). “The inequity of opt-in educational resources and an intervention to increase equitable access.” Half-Baked Seminar, Annenberg Institute, Brown University, Providence, RI.

Research Experience

Research Analyst, SCALE Initiative, Stanford University	2026–Present
Research Analyst, Dr. Emily Penner, UC Irvine	2022–Present
Research Analyst, Annenberg Institute, Brown University	2019–2022
Graduate Fellow, Center for Educational Equity, Teachers College, Columbia University	2018–2019
Research Analyst, Dr. John Papay, Brown University	2018–2019
Research Data Analyst, Education Northwest, Portland, OR	2015–2018
Field Research Analyst, Dr. Alfredo Burlando, University of Oregon, Uganda	2013–2015

Teaching Experience

University of California, Irvine

The Policy Environment of Teaching (EDUC 243), Teaching Assistant	2025
Origins, Purposes, and Central Issues in K–12 Education (EDUC 50), Teaching Assistant	2025

Brown University

Applied Statistics for Education Research and Policy Analysis (EDUC 1230), Guest Lab Instructor	2019
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Professional and Academic Service

Coordinator, Education Policy & Social Context Lab, UC Irvine	2024–2025
Member, PhD Admissions Committee, School of Education, UC Irvine	2023–2024
Board Member, Associated Doctoral Students in Education, UC Irvine	2022–2024
Member, Graduate Student Council, Brown University	2018–2019

Reviewer: *Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)*; *Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP)*

Other

Software: Stata, Python, L^AT_EX, Qualtrics, Dedoose

Languages: English (Fluent), Nepali (Conversational), Hindi (Conversational), Spanish (Beginner)